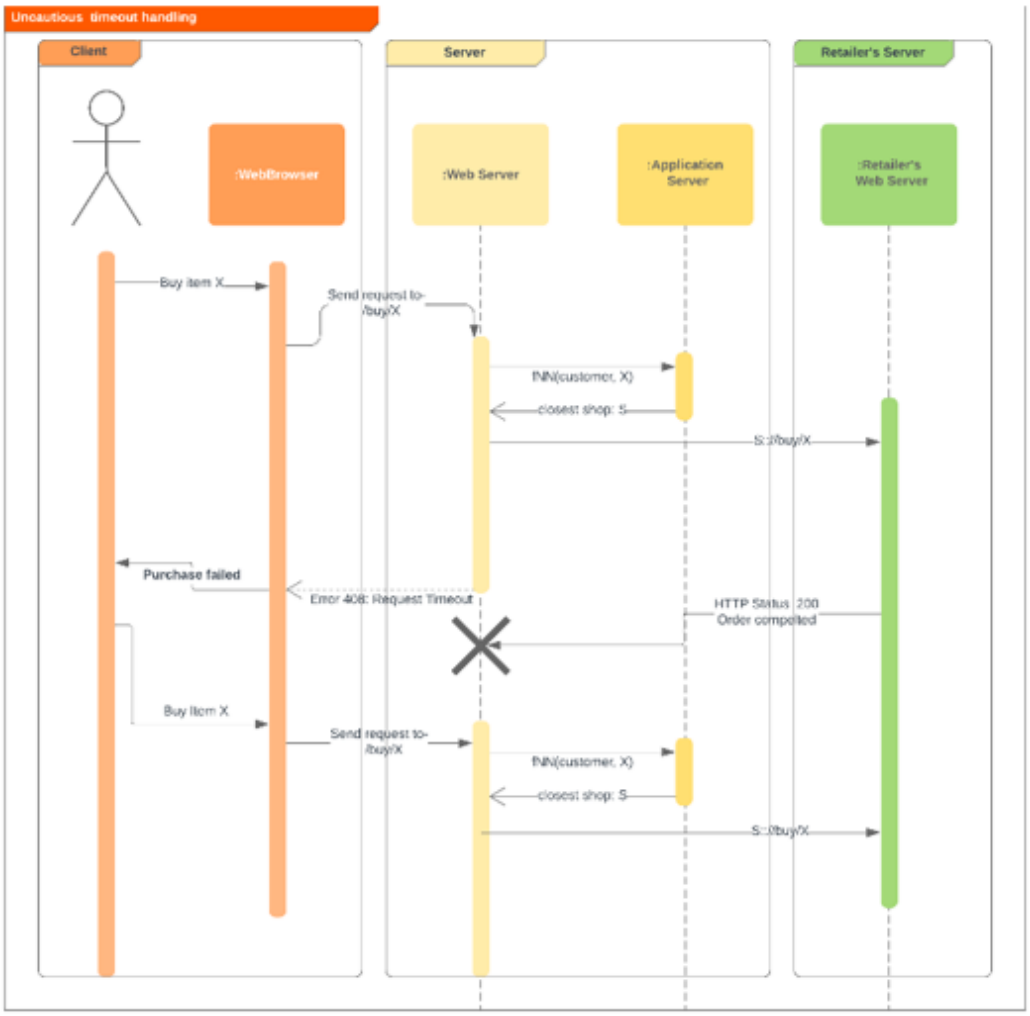


Figure 11.7 A sequence diagram showing how an improper handling of timeouts, when calls to external services are involved, could cause dire consequences. The application's web server times out before receiving an answer from the external service, so the user sees the order didn't go through, while instead the retailer's service had registered it. If the user tries to order the item again, there will be a duplicate.

This introduces additional challenges, because if we keep a longer timeout for our call to the shop's server, there is a chance that the HTTP call from the customer fails, but our